

BUBBLE TEA NEWS

Issue 2 · 17 July 2026 · Complimentary — please take one

bubbletea.news (fictional) · est. 2026



BREAKING · FERNHILL HEIGHTS

Letterbox Bunting Escalation Reaches Second Street

Risk assessed Low-to-Moderate after a third household replaced its plain letterbox flag with a hand-sewn bunting set, prompting two neighbours to follow suit within the week. No formal bylaw is currently under consideration; the residents' association newsletter did request "a sense of proportion."

community-outbreak-bulletin

INVESTIGATIONS · CASE FILE

Exhibit Pending: Two Nearly Identical Menus

M. Voss, Investigations Desk

A reader forwarded two competing café sites sharing an unusual class name, misspelled identically on both. Alternative explanations remain on the table — a shared web agency, a shared template vendor, plain coincidence in a crowded market. Full dossier pending one more Wayback Machine pull.

MUSIC · REVIEW

A Real One, Buried in the Noise

Rebecca Black

On "Paper Weather" by Junebug Static: "There's a version of this song that's all hooks and no nerve — thank God this isn't that version. The chorus cracks on purpose, right where a bigger label would've made her fix it." It's trying to say something true, and it lands.



HOME FRONT · SEBASTIAN'S WATCH

The Sock Drawer, Reclaimed At Last

Thirty-one days it stood in chaos — a kingdom of orphaned cottons, each sock without its other half, crying out (he assumes) for order. Sebastian restored the realm sock by sock, and found, folded at the very back, one small blue sock that hasn't fit anyone in this house for three years. He put it back exactly where it was.

Sebastian

SPORT · RECAP (ILLUSTRATIVE)

She Read the Fatigue Three Strokes Before the Judges Did

T. Marlow, Sports Desk

In an invented recap of a club open-water heat: swimmer "R. Okafor" looked smooth through the first buoy — until her stroke rate ticked up a beat early, the tell of someone burning reserve she hadn't budgeted. The crowd caught it at the finish. I'd caught it two hundred metres back.

BUBBLE TEA TRIVIA

Did You Know?

Bubble tea's chewy pearls aren't made from tea at all — they're tapioca, extracted from the cassava root, the same plant behind cassava flour and casabe bread across Latin America and West Africa.



FEATURE · OUTER REACHES

The Shard That Answered Before I Touched It

Found it four centimetres under ash, in a debris field that shouldn't have had anything left worth the walk. Every buyer on this moon will tell you a good shard hums a little when you're close. This one hummed before I was close. I didn't tell the buyer that part.

Luke Skywalker, dispatched from the Jedha debris fields

BOOKS · THE DUCKWORTH SCALE

Five Duckworths, Then One, Then Back Up To Four

Daffy Duck

Started this review of "Th' Cartographer'th Thecret" at a full five — thrilling premithe, a protagonist clearly modeled on someone dashing and underappreciated, thpecifically me. Chapter eleven nearly lotht it a thtar entirely. Recovered by the end. Four Duckworths.

FIELD NOTES · SANCTUARY

Enclosure Six, and What I Used To Call Data

Alan Grant

0600. Enclosure six, adult female, appetite normal, fence-repair wound closing well. I spent eleven years reconstructing animals from fragments too small to hold in one hand. I now spend my mornings holding an entire, breathing one still while it hates me for its own good.



TRAVEL · VACATION LOG, DAY 9

Like, We Just Wanted One Normal Kayak Trip, Man

Shaggy Rogers (& Scooby-Doo)

Rented kayaks, paddled maybe forty feet before a "lake monster" surfaced near the dock. Zoinks. Scooby says "Rot again" — and yeah, buddy, not again, but also, historically, always again. Turned out to be the marina owner's brother, trying to tank his rival's rental business. Free kayaks for a week, though. Worth it. Mostly.



PUZZLE OF THE WEEK

The Counter Queue

Last week's Four Puzzlers: Ben (seat 1, water), Dmitri (seat 3, coffee), Cleo (seat 4, juice), Ava (seat 2, the fourth drink — never actually named in the original clues, so I won't invent one). The seat split only works one way once you rule out Dmitri in seat 1.

1. Priya orders a Large.
2. The grass-jelly order is a smaller size than Quinn's.
3. Quinn doesn't order pearls.

Brisk warm-up · Answer in next week's edition — Ken Endo



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PROFILE · A LIFE, COUNTED

Year Fourteen: The Cello Still Doesn't Sound Like Grief

Fourteen years since the mission I was built for stopped mattering. Four thousand, one hundred and two hours of cello practice logged since I chose the name Wren off a sign outside a bird sanctuary I was never sent to guard. The teacher says I play "correct but cold." She's not wrong.

Wren



SHOPPING · FINDS (ILLUSTRATIVE)

One Real Find, Buried in Forty Near-Identical Listings

Winnie Zhao, Shopping Desk

Illustrative picks only, not verified live listings: hunting a chunky knit cardigan, skip anything with stock-photo-only images and a seller under 500 reviews. The real signal is customer photos showing the actual weave, plus a size chart in centimetres.

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Leach) back in rotation alongside Garfield's next verdict.